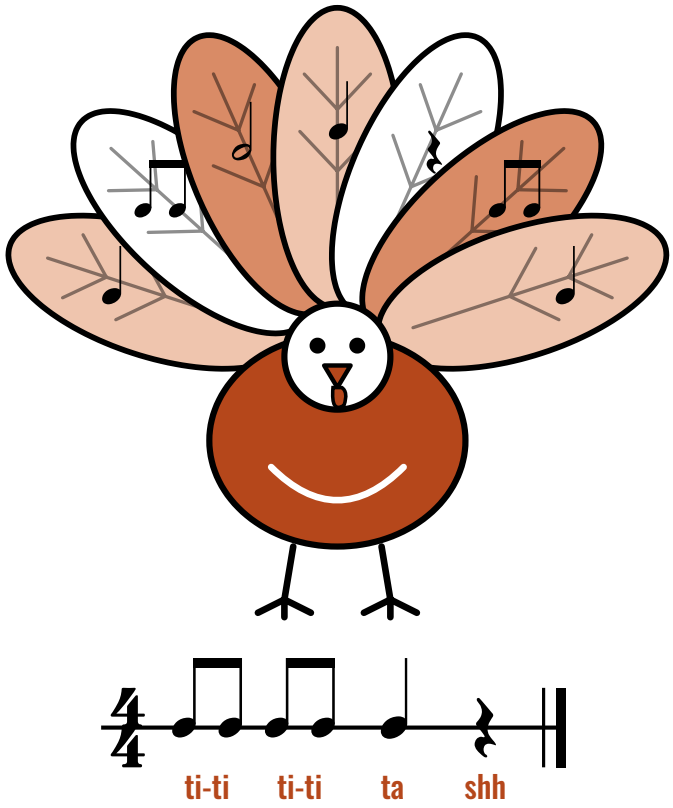
HUDSON BEAT



THANKSGIVING MUSIC SUB PLAN

3 no-prep lessons · turkey rhythm reading · gratitude lyrics · listening response

GRADES K–5 · 3 LESSONS · 6 WORKSHEETS · 18 PAGES

TEACHER NOTES

Thanksgiving Music Sub Plan K–5 · 3 no-prep lessons

WHAT IT IS

Three complete music lessons for Thanksgiving week that a substitute can teach with no tech, no instruments and no music background (Lesson 3 needs a way to play one piece of music you choose). Each has a step-by-step plan with words to say, timed steps, and two worksheets: one for grades K–2 and one for grades 3–5.

THE THREE LESSONS

1. **Turkey Rhythm Reading**: reading and clapping rhythms.
2. **Gratitude Lyrics**: writing a gratitude chant or verse.
3. **Thankful Listening**: listening and responding to music.

Use them in any order; each lesson takes 30 to 45 minutes. The welcome sheet has a "Lesson #" column so the sub knows which one each class gets next.

SET UP THE SUB TUB (ABOUT 15 MINUTES, ONCE)

1. Fill in the welcome sheet (page 3), including the listening music for Lesson 3.
2. Print the plans, the rhythm chart and the sub report; copy each worksheet for your largest class.
3. Put each lesson in its own folder with its worksheets, and add the answer key.

LESSON 3 LISTENING MUSIC

No audio is included. Choose a calm instrumental piece you already have the right to play in class, about 2 to 3 minutes long, and write how to start it on the welcome sheet. If your sub has no audio, the plan gives a no-tech sound show instead.

WHAT'S INSIDE

PART	PAGES	USE
For the substitute	3–4	welcome sheet, lessons at a glance, game bank
Rhythm chart	5	8 lines with syllables, for Lessons 1 and 3 games
Lesson 1 · Turkey Rhythm Reading	6–8	plan + K–2 and 3–5 sheets
Lesson 2 · Gratitude Lyrics	9–11	plan + K–2 and 3–5 sheets
Lesson 3 · Thankful Listening	12–14	plan + K–2 and 3–5 response sheets
Early finishers	15	draw, write and clap, K–5
Answer key	16	Lesson 1 answers and Lesson 2 syllable counts
Sub report	17	notes back to you
Terms of use	18	license and credits

ABOUT THE NOTATION

Rhythms are in 4/4 and use quarter notes, paired eighth notes, quarter rests, half notes and whole notes, engraved with a professional music font. Every rhythm is read back by computer and checked for 4 beats per bar, except the bars in Lesson 1 part B that students must spot as wrong; the key comes from the same checked data. Each example lyric line is counted by computer too.

STANDARDS

Supports reading rhythm notation (MU:Pr4.2), creating original lyrics and rhythms (MU:Cr2.1) and describing what students hear (MU:Re7.2), National Core Arts Standards, Music, grades K–5.

GOOD TO KNOW

- Prints well in black and white.
- Not every family celebrates Thanksgiving. The lessons are about food, gratitude and music, with no history lesson and no required beliefs, and every student can pass or choose their own thankful word.
- Rhythm syllables follow the common ta / ti-ti system.

All lessons, chants, verses, games, words and art are original. No songs, lyrics or copyrighted characters are used.

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THANKSGIVING MUSIC SUB PLAN

Welcome, substitute · fill in and keep on top

FOR THE SUB

Welcome sheet

Teacher: fill this in once and keep it on top of the sub folder. Substitute: welcome, and thank you! Everything you need for today is in this folder.

Teacher _____ **Nearby teacher who can help** _____

Room _____ **Their room** _____

School office ext. _____ **Date updated** _____

TODAY'S CLASSES · Use the lesson number you have not used yet with that class.

TIME	CLASS / GRADE	LESSON #	NOTES

LISTENING MUSIC FOR LESSON 3 · Teacher: choose a calm instrumental piece or two that you may play in class.

Title / composer _____ **Where to find it / how to play it** _____

HOW WE DO THINGS ·

Attention signal _____

Entering the room _____

Where students sit _____

Bathroom / water _____

Lining up / dismissal _____

WHERE THINGS ARE ·

Copies of worksheets _____

Pencils _____

Seating charts _____

Emergency plans _____

Class lists _____

No music background needed. Each lesson has a step-by-step plan with words to say, and every rhythm has its syllables printed under the notes. Please leave notes on the sub report (page 17).

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THANKSGIVING MUSIC SUB PLAN

Lessons at a glance and game bank

FOR THE SUB

3 lessons, any order

Each lesson is one 30–45 minute music class. Every lesson works for any grade K–5: use the plan page, then hand out the **K–2** or **3–5** sheet. The lessons can be used in any order, and each one works on its own.

LESSON	LESSON	K–2 SHEET	3–5 SHEET	PLAN PAGE
1	**Turkey Rhythm Reading** Reading and clapping rhythms · about 45 min	Feather Rhythms page 7	Turkey Rhythm Math page 8	6
2	**Gratitude Lyrics** Writing a gratitude chant or verse · about 40 min	My Thankful Chant page 10	Gratitude Verse page 11	9
3	**Thankful Listening** Listening and responding to music · about 40 min	My Listening Page page 13	Listening Response page 14	12

GAME BANK · No-prep games for extra time. No equipment, no tech.

GAME	HOW TO PLAY	LESSON
Turkey Trot Echo	Clap a short line from the chart; the class echoes it exactly. Change the speed and the loudness.	1
Gobble and Freeze	Clap chart lines in any order. Everyone echoes except for the chosen gobble line: silence.	1
Pass the Pie	Pass a clapped rhythm from student to student. Does it arrive the same?	1
Thankful Circle	Pat a steady beat. Each student says one thing they are thankful for in one beat. Passing is allowed.	2
Silent Conductor	A student conducts the class's claps: hands far apart = loud, close together = soft, fists = stop.	3
Feast Freeze	March in place to a steady beat; freeze when the beat stops. Name a food to act out when you freeze.	3

TIPS FOR A CALM CLASS ·

- Use the teacher's attention signal from the welcome sheet (page 3), or clap a short rhythm and have the class clap it back.
- "Strong voice, not shouting" keeps the loud parts happy and safe.
- If a game gets too loud, switch to a worksheet or Feast Freeze.
- Students may have very different holiday plans. Keep the talk on gratitude, food and music, and let anyone pass.

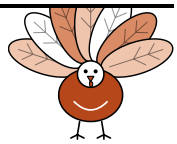
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THANKSGIVING MUSIC SUB PLAN

Turkey rhythm chart · show it or copy a line on the board

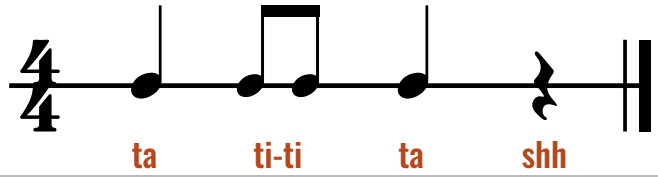
FOR THE SUB

Lesson 1 and games

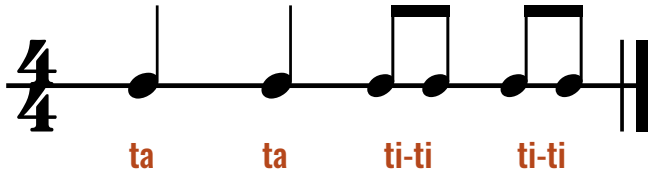


Clap and say each line; the class echoes. Say the words under the notes; you do not need to read music. Silent beats (**shh**): open your hands, no sound.

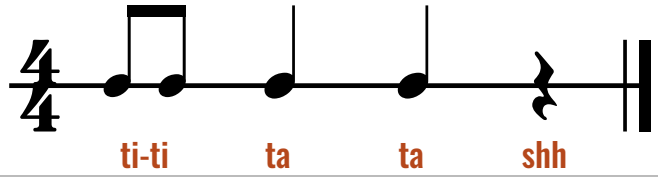
1 K–5



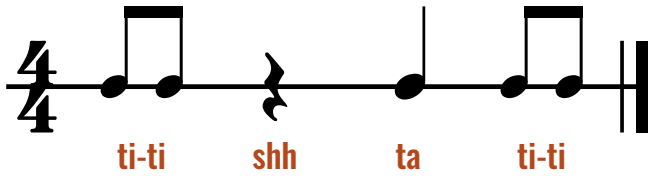
2 K–5



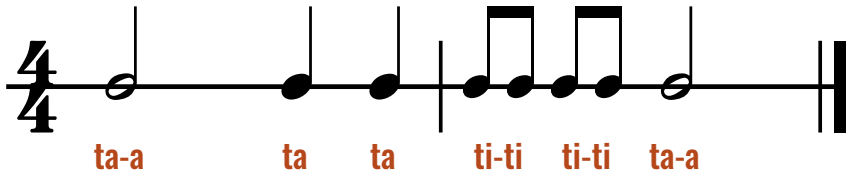
3 K–5



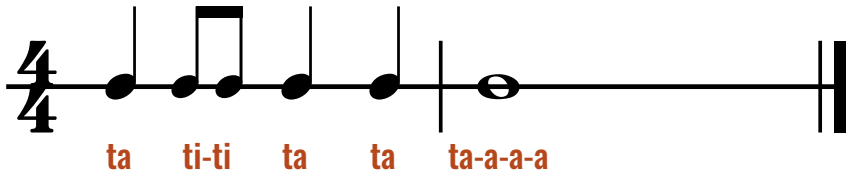
4 K–5



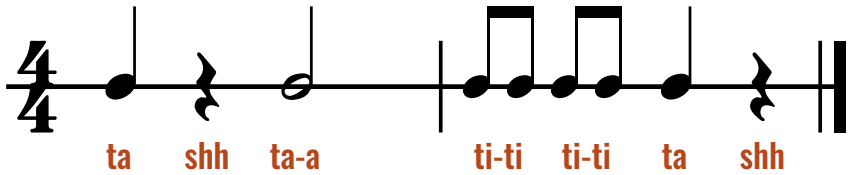
5 3–5



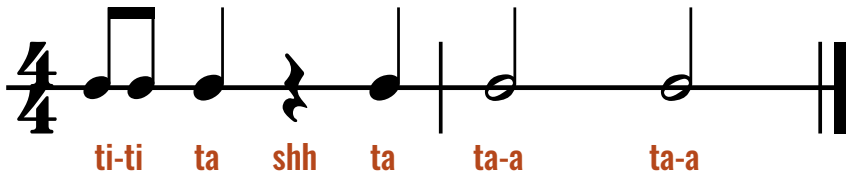
6 3–5



7 3–5



8 3–5



ta = quarter note (1 beat) · **ti-ti** = two eighth notes (1 beat) · **shh** = quarter rest (1 beat) · **ta-a** = half note (2 beats) · **ta-a-a-a** = whole note (4 beats)

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TURKEY RHYTHM READING

LESSON 1

Lesson 1 · Reading and clapping rhythms · no tech, no prep

Sub plan

GOAL
Students clap, say and read rhythms with ta, ti-ti and shh (grades 3–5 add ta-a and ta-a-a-a).

YOU NEED
Pencils, the rhythm chart (page 5) shown or copied on the board, and the worksheets.

COPIES
K–2: page 7
3–5: page 8
about 45 min

STEP BY STEP · Italic lines are words you can say.

5 min Step 1

TURKEY TROT ECHO

Say: *"Happy November, musicians! I'm your guest teacher today. Let's warm up. Echo me!"* Say each line and let the class repeat it: *Ears are on. Eyes are up. Hands are still. Let's make music!* Then pat a slow, steady beat on your knees and have the class pat along.

10 min Step 2

LEARN THE RHYTHM WORDS

Show the rhythm chart (page 5). Point to the key at the bottom: **ta** is one clap, **ti-ti** is two quick claps, **shh** is a silent beat (open hands, no sound). Say line 1 aloud, then clap it. The class echoes. Do lines 1 to 4 with every class. Grades 3–5 also try lines 5 to 8, which add **ta-a** (a long sound, 2 beats) and **ta-a-a-a** (4 beats).

10 min Step 3

GOBBLE AND FREEZE

Pick one chart line as the **gobble line**. Clap lines in any order. The class echoes every line, but when the gobble line comes they stay silent and gobble quietly with their hands over their mouths. Let a student leader choose the lines for the last round.

15 min Step 4

WORKSHEETS

Hand out the worksheet: **K–2** Feather Rhythms (page 7), **3–5** Turkey Rhythm Math (page 8). Read the directions aloud. Clap each rhythm out loud with the class first if students ask. Answers are on page 16.

5 min Step 5

PASS THE PIE

Sit in a circle or stay in rows. Clap a short rhythm to the first student, who claps it to the next, and so on. Does it arrive the same? Ask: *Which rhythm was the hardest to pass?*

Extra time? Students make up a 4-beat rhythm of their own with pie, corn, tur-key and shh, then clap it for a neighbor. Or use the early finishers page (page 15). **Short class?** Do steps 1 to 3 and send the worksheet home to finish.

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FEATHER RHYTHMS

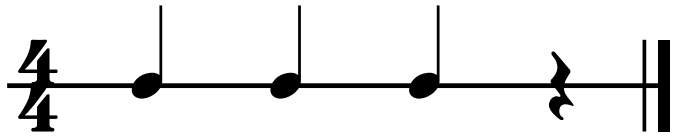
Clap, count and match

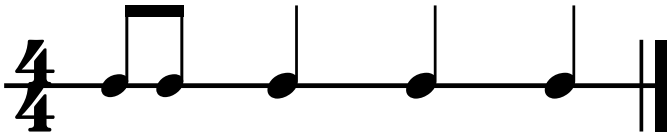
LESSON 1

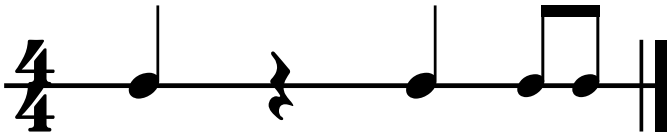
Grades K–2

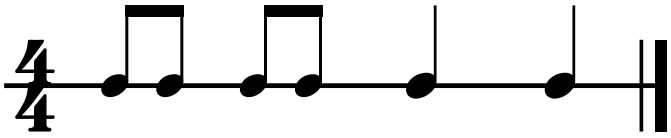
Name _____ Date _____

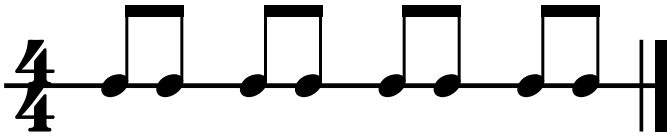
A · HOW MANY SOUNDS? Clap each feather rhythm. Write how many claps you hear. (A rest is silent.)

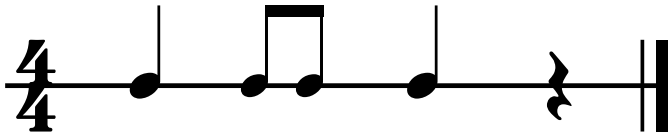
1  claps ☐

2  claps ☐

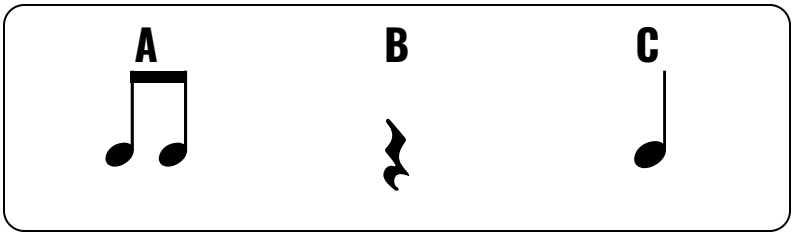
3  claps ☐

4  claps ☐

5  claps ☐

6  claps ☐

B · WORD RHYTHMS Say and clap each word. Write the letter of its rhythm.



pie ☐

gob-ble ☐

shh ☐

corn ☐

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TURKEY RHYTHM MATH

LESSON 1

Add the beats, check the bars, say the rhythm

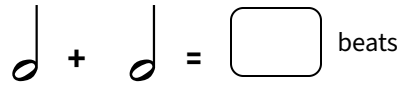
Grades 3–5

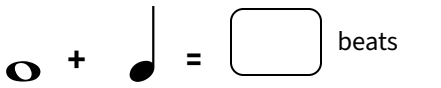
Name _____ Date _____

Beats: quarter note = 1 · two eighth notes = 1 · quarter rest = 1 · half note = 2 · whole note = 4

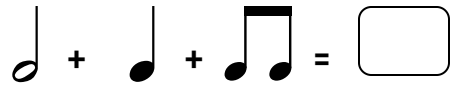
A · RHYTHM MATH Add up the beats.

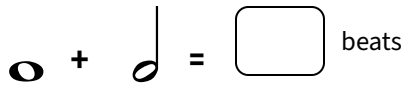
1  beats

2  beats

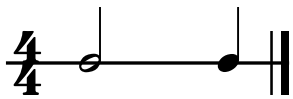
3  beats

4  beats

5  beats

6  beats

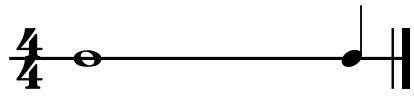
B · IS IT 4 BEATS? In 4/4 time every bar needs 4 beats. Count each bar. Circle YES or NO.

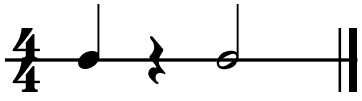
1  YES NO beats: ____

2  YES NO beats: ____

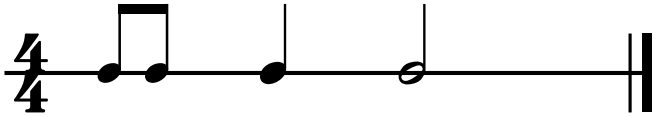
3  YES NO beats: ____

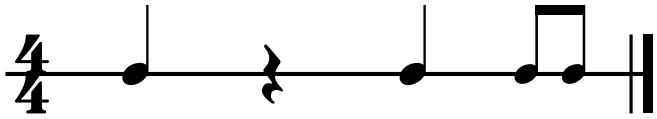
4  YES NO beats: ____

5  YES NO beats: ____

6  YES NO beats: ____

C · SAY IT Write the rhythm syllables (ta, ti-ti, shh, ta-a) for each rhythm.

1  _____

2  _____

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GRATITUDE LYRICS

LESSON 2

Lesson 2 · Writing a gratitude chant or verse · no tech, no prep

Sub plan

GOAL
Students write original thankful lyrics to a steady beat: a one-beat word chant (K–2) or a four-line rhyming verse (3–5).

YOU NEED
Pencils, the worksheets, and the board for the class chant. No instruments needed.

COPIES
K–2: page 10
3–5: page 11
about 40 min

STEP BY STEP · Italic lines are words you can say.

5 min Step 1

THANKFUL CIRCLE

Everyone pats a slow, steady beat. Go around the room: each student says one thing they are thankful for in a single beat, such as *pie*, *pup* or *sun*. Anyone can pass. **Tip:** thankful can be anything small, a pet, a sunny day, a good book or a hot meal. Not every family celebrates Thanksgiving, and that is fine; this lesson is about noticing good things.

10 min Step 2

WRITE A CLASS CHANT

On the board, write **Thank you for _____.** Say it on a steady beat (*Thank*, *you*, *for* and then a word of your own on beat 4). Take word ideas from the class and chant each line together. A one-syllable word is one clap (**ta**); a two-syllable word, like *turkey*, is two quick claps (**ti-ti**).

15 min Step 3

WORKSHEETS

Hand out the worksheet: **K–2** My Thankful Chant (page 10), **3–5** Gratitude Verse (page 11). Grades 3–5: read the example verse aloud on a steady beat, and show students how to count syllables on their fingers. A line should have exactly 7 syllables and then a silent beat. This lesson has no answer key because every answer is the student's own.

10 min Step 4

SHARE AND CHANT

Invite volunteers to read or chant their lines while the class pats the beat. Praise one specific thing: a funny word, a great rhyme or a line that fits the beat perfectly. Finish with the whole class chanting *Thank you for _____*, each student adding their own word.

Extra time? Add a second verse, or turn a favorite line into a poster with a drawing. Or use the early finishers page (page 15). **Short class?** Do steps 1 and 2, then let students start the worksheet.

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MY THANKFUL CHANT

Chant something you are thankful for

LESSON 2

Grades K–2

Name _____ Date _____

Each box is **one beat**. The first three beats say **Thank you for**. In the last box, write or draw something you are thankful for. One-syllable word = **ta** (one note). Two-syllable word = **ti-ti** (two notes joined). Draw its note, then chant your line on a steady beat!

One syllable (ta): pie · corn · yam · home · sun · food · friends · love · dog · cat
Two syllables (ti-ti): tur-key · pump-kin · ap-ple · to-day · mu-sic · teach-er · sis-ter · grand-ma · kit-ten · co-zy
Your own words are welcome too.

EXAMPLES

Thank you for pie (one syllable, ta). Thank you for tur-key would use ti-ti.

Thank	you	for	pie
			

MY CHANT

Write 3 lines of your own.

Thank	you	for	
			
Thank	**you**	**for**	
			
Thank	**you**	**for**	
			

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GRATITUDE VERSE

Write a four-line gratitude verse to a steady beat

LESSON 2

Grades 3–5

Name _____ Date _____

Write a 4-line thankful verse. Every line has **7 syllables** (one in each box) and then one silent beat, so it fits 8 beats of music. Lines 1 and 2 rhyme (A), and lines 3 and 4 rhyme (B).

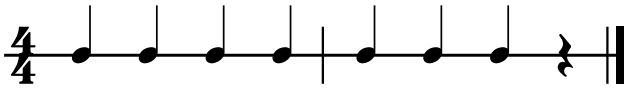
A · READ THE EXAMPLE

Syllables are counted for you. Rhyme words are in color.

A	Thank-ful for the gold-en **trees**	7 syllables
A	Thank-ful for the cool fall **breeze**	7 syllables
B	Pie and corn and rolls to **share**	7 syllables
B	Thank-ful for good friends who **care**	7 syllables

B · THE BEAT

7 syllables on 7 beats, then **shh** (a silent beat).



Tap the beat on your desk and say one syllable on each tap. Rest on the last tap.

C · WRITE YOUR VERSE

One syllable per box. Write the number of syllables you wrote at the end of each line.

A								____
A								____
B								____
B								____

Verse title _____

D · CHECK IT

Tick each box when it is true.

- ☐ Every line has exactly 7 syllables.
- ☐ Lines 1 and 2 rhyme, and lines 3 and 4 rhyme.
- ☐ I can chant my whole verse on a steady beat, with a rest at the end of each line.

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THANKFUL LISTENING

LESSON 3

Lesson 3 · Listening and responding to music · no tech, no prep

Sub plan

GOAL
Students listen carefully to one piece of music and describe its speed, loudness, instruments and mood.

YOU NEED
The listening music your teacher chose (see the welcome sheet, page 3), a way to play it, pencils and the worksheets. No audio is included in this resource.

COPIES
K–2: page 13
3–5: page 14
about 40 min

STEP BY STEP · Italic lines are words you can say.

5 min Step 1

LISTENING EARS

Say: *"A good listener has quiet hands, a quiet voice and open ears. Today we listen the way a musician does."* Ask: **What sounds can you hear in the room right now?** Take 3 or 4 answers.

5 min Step 2

MUSIC WORDS

Read the words on the student sheet aloud. K–2: **loud, soft, fast, slow, happy, calm**. 3–5: **tempo, dynamics, instrument families, mood**. Act them out: clap loud and soft, walk fast and slow.

10 min Step 3

FIRST LISTEN: JUST LISTEN

Play the music your teacher chose (about 2 to 3 minutes). Students close their eyes or look down and **only listen**. No audio today? Do the sound show instead: clap, stomp and whisper in a pattern of soft, loud, soft, fast, slow, and let students describe what changed.

15 min Step 4

SECOND LISTEN: FILL IN THE SHEET

Hand out the worksheet: **K–2** My Listening Page (page 13), **3–5** Listening Response (page 14). Play the music again and let students fill in the sheet as it plays. Play it a third time if there is time. There are no wrong answers, because each student describes what they heard.

5 min Step 5

TURN AND TALK

Partners share one thing they heard and one thing they imagined. Then ask: *Who heard something different from their partner?*

Extra time? Students draw a second picture for a different scene, or write 3 sentences about the music. Or use the early finishers page (page 15). **Short class?** Do steps 1, 3 and 4 only.

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MY LISTENING PAGE

Close your eyes and listen like a musician

LESSON 3

Grades K–2

Name _____ Date _____

Listen to the music. **Draw** what you picture. **Circle** one word in each row.

Draw what you see in your mind.

THE MUSIC WAS ·

LOUD		SOFT
FAST		SLOW
HAPPY	CALM	SLEEPY

I HEARD · Circle all you heard.

DRUMS	PIANO	VOICES
STRINGS	HORNS	FLUTES

This music made me feel _____

I liked it: **A LOT** **A LITTLE** **NOT YET**

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LISTENING RESPONSE

Listen, describe and explain what you hear

LESSON 3

Grades 3–5

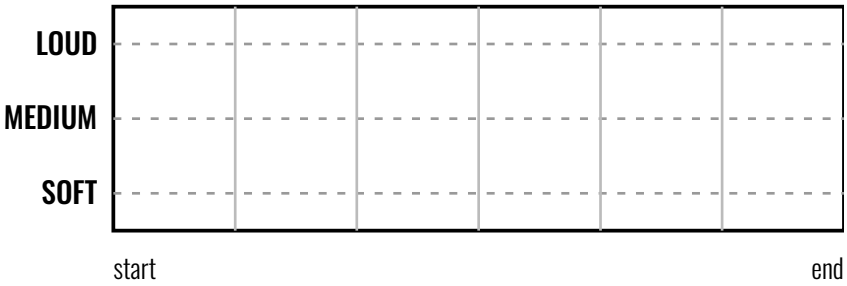
Name _____ Date _____

Music title _____ **Composer (if known)** _____

A · TEMPO Circle the speed of the music.

ADAGIO slow **MODERATO** medium **ALLEGRO** fast

B · DYNAMICS Draw a line to show how loud or soft the music gets from start to end.



C · INSTRUMENTS Tick every group you hear.

- ☐ Strings
- ☐ Woodwinds
- ☐ Brass
- ☐ Percussion
- ☐ Piano / keyboard
- ☐ Voices

D · MOOD Circle up to three words.

CALM **HAPPY** **PEACEFUL** **EXCITED** **SLEEPY** **COZY** **PROUD** **THOUGHTFUL** **PLAYFUL** **GRAND**

E · EXPLAIN Finish the sentences.

This music would fit a scene about _____ because _____

One thing I heard that I want to remember is _____

If I could add one instrument or sound, it would be _____

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EARLY FINISHERS

Early finishers · grades K–5

ANY LESSON

Early finishers

Name _____ Date _____

Finished early? Pick one (or do them all).

THANKFUL TURKEY

Write or draw one thing you are thankful for on each feather. Color the turkey.

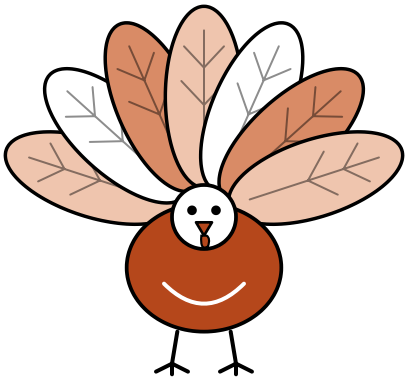
I'm thankful for…

I'm thankful for…

I'm thankful for…

I'm thankful for…

I'm thankful for…



MY 4-BEAT THANKFUL RHYTHM

One word or note in each beat box. Clap it for a friend.

beat 1	beat 2	beat 3	beat 4

MY MUSIC WORDS

Write 3 sentences using a music word: beat, loud, soft, fast, slow, high, low.

_____

_____

_____

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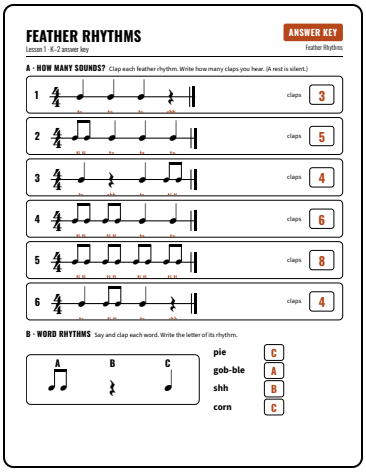
THANKSGIVING MUSIC SUB PLAN

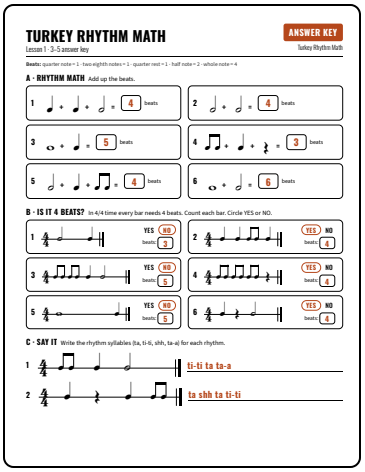
Answer key · Lesson 1 and Lesson 2 example

ANSWER KEY

Lessons 1 and 2

Lesson 1 answers. The small pages are the filled-in worksheets; the tables list every answer.





K–2	RHYTHM	ANSWER
A1	ta ta ta shh	3
A2	ti-ti ta ta ta	5
A3	ta shh ta ti-ti	4
A4	ti-ti ti-ti ta ta	6
A5	ti-ti ti-ti ti-ti ti-ti	8
A6	ta ti-ti ta shh	4
B · pie	ta	C
B · gob-ble	ti-ti	A
B · shh	shh	B
B · corn	ta	C

3–5	WORK	ANSWER
A1	1 + 1 + 2	4
A2	2 + 2	4
A3	4 + 1	5
A4	1 + 1 + 1	3
A5	2 + 1 + 1	4
A6	4 + 2	6
B1	ta-a ta	NO · 3
B2	ta ta ti-ti ta	YES · 4
B3	ti-ti ti-ti ta ta-a	NO · 5
B4	ti-ti ti-ti ti-ti shh	YES · 4
B5	ta-a-a-a ta	NO · 5
B6	ta shh ta-a	YES · 4
C1	ti-ti ta ta-a	
C2	ta shh ta ti-ti	

LESSON 2 · EXAMPLE VERSE (page 11)

RHYME	LINE	SYLLABLES
A	Thank-ful for the gold-en trees	7
A	Thank-ful for the cool fall breeze	7
B	Pie and corn and rolls to share	7
B	Thank-ful for good friends who care	7

LESSONS 2 AND 3

Answers are the students' own. For the K–2 chant, check that each last word fits its note: a one-syllable word on **ta** and a two-syllable word on **ti-ti**. For the 3–5 verse, check 7 syllables a line and the AABB rhymes. For the listening sheets, accept any answer a student can explain.

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THANKSGIVING MUSIC SUB PLAN

Sub report · notes for the music teacher

FOR THE SUB

Leave on the desk

Substitute: thank you! Please fill this in and leave it on the teacher's desk.

Your name _____ **Date** _____

CLASS / GRADE	LESSON #	WHAT WE FINISHED	NOTES

STUDENTS WHO WERE A BIG HELP ·

ANYTHING I SHOULD KNOW? ·

GAMES WE PLAYED ·

- ☐ Turkey Trot Echo
- ☐ Pass the Pie
- ☐ Silent Conductor
- ☐ Gobble and Freeze
- ☐ Thankful Circle
- ☐ Feast Freeze

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